

THE FALSE EMPLOYEE

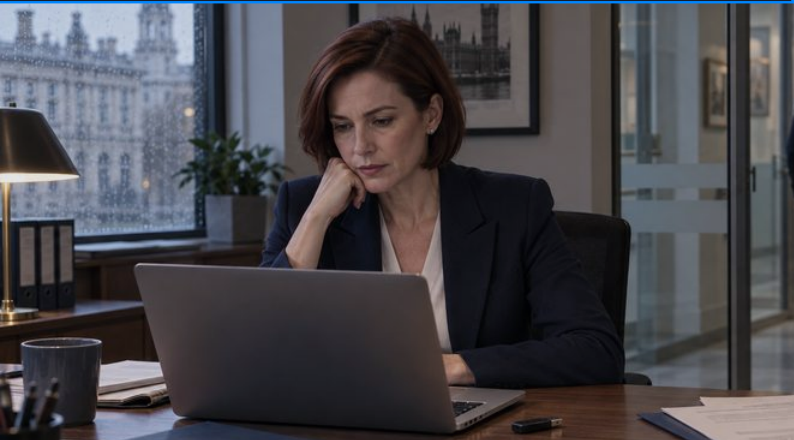
A recent contractor had passed every check, received a badge, and entered the building without challenge. Nothing in the routine paperwork looked alarming.

When the records were examined together, small inconsistencies appeared. Lestrade sealed the files before anyone decided they were harmless.



One contractor badge had entered the corridor near Clara Voss's office. The visitor looked like any support worker carrying routine equipment.

Soon afterward, Clara used a device presented as an update. Her workstation was preserved, but what had happened and who was responsible remained unproven.



The timeline proved that the apparent update continued working after its visible task ended. It collected far more than it declared and reported outward.

The visitor had not merely entered the building. The visit had quietly turned an ordinary workstation into part of the operation.



Among the captured material was a reference to an external developer supporting an emergency HR application. A separate clue suggested that the visitor's identity had been prepared deliberately.

The listening post had supplied the next door. The investigation now turned toward Tom Ainsworth.



MORAN'S DOOR

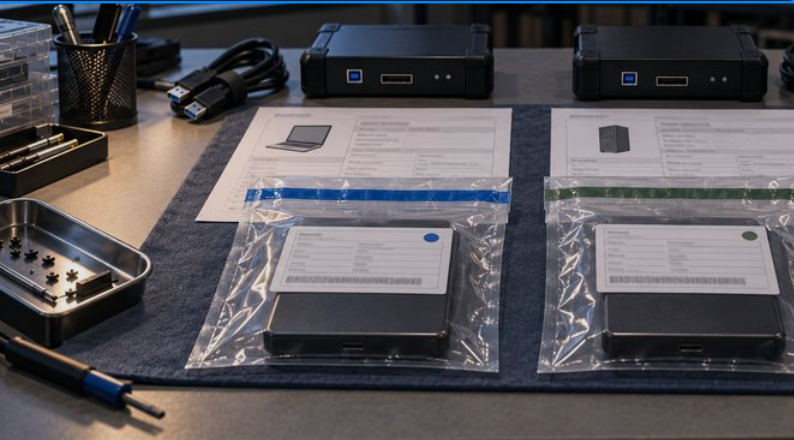
Tom Ainsworth supported an emergency HR application. He was not close to the secret system, but he was close to its people.

Tom admitted installing a useful-looking public repository. His workstation soon behaved strangely. Lestrade preserved it and a temporary server image.



The HR application served staff across Whitehall, placing ordinary administrative data beside people close to sensitive work. The extent of the compromise remained unknown.

Investigators faced two questions: what had the poisoned repository installed, and how far had the intruder travelled afterward?



POST-SOLVE CONTENT HIDDEN
REVEAL AFTER SHERLOCK